



S – Situation When and where did it happen?

Anchor it in one specific moment. "In the ten o'clock meeting this morning," not "lately" or "a few times now."

Write yours:

B – Behavior What did they actually do?

Describe what you observed, the way a camera would have caught it. No interpretation, no motive, no verdict on the person. "You cut across Dana twice while she was still talking."

Write yours:

I – Impact What effect did it have?

This is what makes the behavior worth changing. Name the consequence on the work, the client, or the person. "She didn't say anything for the rest of the meeting."

Write yours:

What is sounds like put together:

"In the ten o'clock meeting, you cut across Dana twice while she was still talking. After the second time, she went quiet for the rest of the meeting."

Nothing to defend against, because you described what happened, not what it says about them.

Behavior vs Character

Say This:

"You interrupted Dana twice this morning."

"The last two client emails went out with the wrong figures."

"The report came in two days after the deadline."

Not This:

"You're kind of a steamroller."

"You've been careless lately."

"You don't take deadlines seriously."

Before you start:

If you can't name a specific behavior, you're not ready to have the conversation. Go find the specifics first. Softening isn't kindness. "No big deal, but maybe try to be more careful" reads as small talk, and nothing changes. You can be warm about something specific.

If they get defensive:

Expect it, and don't drop your point. If they raise a real constraint, hold both: "That process may genuinely need fixing, and I want to hear where. And these handoffs still have to happen." The word is and, not but.